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Sports | D5*

GIRLS DIVISION II REGIONAL SEMIS

Dobbs keeps Blazers' dream aflame

BOB FORTUNA
Plain Dealer Reporter

One of the smallest players on the floor made one of the biggest impacts in helping her team keep its ultimate goal alive Tuesday night at Barberton High School.

Alexis Dobbs stands only 5-5, but the freshman guard scored nine points, had five steals and dished out four assists as Hathaway Brown edged Holy Name, 37-34, in a Division II regional semifinal girls basketball game.

The victory advanced the Blazers (20-4) to Friday's 7:30 p.m. regional championship against Canal Fulton Northwest (21-4) with the winner earning a trip to the state tournament. Northwest defeated Youngstown Rayen, 48-39, in the other semifinal.

"This feels real good," said Dobbs, who with the help of 5-4 sophomore guard Kirsten Holmes, ran the Blazers' offense to near-perfection against a stubborn Holy Name zone defense. "We tried to drive in and penetrate to create space for our post players."

Dobbs' three-point play with 6:55 remaining gave HB a 30-28 lead only to have Holy Name

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sophomore Megan Krakowiak tie it on a layup.

A soft 5-foot jumper by Alyssa Reinhart put Holy Name ahead, 34-32, but Dobbs struck for another three-point play with 2:43 left. That gave the Blazers the lead for good at 35-34 and forced the Green Wave to foul where Dobbs again answered the call.

Hitting both ends of a two-shot foul, Dobbs, 5-for-5 from the line, extended the Blazers' lead to 37-34. Two Holy Name turnovers followed to put HB in the regional final for the first time.

"[Holy Name] played a lot of zone the last time," said Blazers coach Paul Barlow, whose team edged the Green Wave, 56-53, in double overtime during the regular season. "This time, though it was more of a 2-3 zone than a 3-2 zone."

"Zone has given us trouble all year because it kind of slows us down and takes us out of our transition game. We tried to flat-



JOHN KUNTZ / THE PLAIN DEALER
Hathaway Brown's Kirsten Holmes (left) does all she can to deny the ball from Holy Name's Nancy Faulhaber in the final seconds Tuesday. Hathaway Brown won the game, 37-34.

ten [the zone] out and get some dribble penetration from our guards, but it was a battle."

Holmes, who scored a team-high 10 points, added four assists and two steals.

"This is great," Barlow said. "This our first chance to get down to Columbus. I told the girls we're 32 minutes away from getting there. We worked

so hard to get here, we're going to put everything we've got out there on the floor on Friday."

Holy Name, which ends its Cinderella postseason march with a 13-11 record, had senior Brittany Nair lead all scorers with 12 points.

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GIRLS DIVISION I REGIONAL SEMIS

Bulldogs power way to win over Mentor

TIM ROGERS
Plain Dealer Reporter

CANTON — They wanted to win for their fallen teammate and they wanted to win for themselves.

Using a decisive 18-2 run over a span of a little less than five minutes, which included an 11-0 blitz to start the second half, Stow's girls defeated Mentor, 57-44, on Tuesday in the first game of a Division I regional semifinal doubleheader in the Memorial Civic Center.

The fallen teammate was junior Chrissy Schaffer, who was taken to Akron Children's Hospital after being kicked in the head inadvertently while diving for a loose ball with 5:16 left in the third quarter. After the game, Stow Athletic Director Cyle Feldman said Schaffer had experienced tingling in her fingers and had a bump on her neck but was feeling better.

"We wanted to win for Chrissy, but we wanted to win for ourselves, too," said senior Cate Cianchetti. Stow coach Bob Podges told his team, "Chrissy plays like a Stow Bulldog. Now you go out and play like her. Don't let her down."

They didn't and will play highly regarded North Canton Hoover (21-3) in Friday's finals

at 7:30 p.m. Hoover, led by talented junior Brittany Orban, defeated Shaker Heights in the second game.

Not only did the loss end Mentor's (17-7) season, it probably ended Mark Chicone's coaching career at Mentor after five seasons and 105 victories. He was told at midseason that his supplemental coaching contract would not be renewed.

Stow (22-3) will make the school's second appearance in the last three years in the regional finals. It trailed, 27-20, with 2:01 remaining in the first half when junior Emily Ritchie made a free throw that began a run that continued deep into the second half.

Hoover 69, Shaker Heights 51

Hoover (21-3) led by eight at the half and outscored Shaker Heights, 24-11, in the third quarter to take a 57-36 lead. Orban, one of Ohio's top juniors, finished with 29 points, 11 rebounds, four assists and two steals. Shaker (19-6) trailed, 17-5, after 64 minutes and tried to rally behind senior Shanna Thompson and junior Aja Fitten, who finished with 11 and 10 points, respectively.

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HIGH SCHOOL ROUNDUP

Badgers rally late, upend Pymatuning Valley

From staff reports

A strong fourth quarter propelled sixth-seeded Berkshire to an upset victory over No. 2-seed Pymatuning Valley, 57-54, Tuesday night in a boys Division III district semifinal basketball game at Lakeland Community College.

The Badgers outscored Py Valley, 19-13, in the final stanza. Kelly Blair led the winners with 17 points, adding three assists and one steal. Ben Hess also had a key performance for Berkshire, scoring 13 points with 12 rebounds, two blocked shots, two steals and one assist.

Olmsted Falls 71, Vermilion 46 The Bulldogs, the top seed at the Division I Westlake district, breezed to their 20th victory in 22 games by virtue of outstanding guard duty. Tyler

Sparks, a senior, led the winners with 23 points, going 14-of-17 from the free throw line, while junior Pat Pellerite had 18 points, including nine in the third quarter when the Bulldogs blew the game open. The No. 4-seeded Sailors got 18 points from senior center Colin Voreis, and bow out with a 15-7 record.

Firestone 59, Stow 40 In the Division I district at Copley, the top-seeded Falcons improved to 16-5 as senior forward Joseph Pope scored 21 points, including 15 in the second half. Junior guard Ramel Mitchell scored eight of his 15 points in the third quarter. No. 5 seeded Stow, 14-9, trailed, 21-19, at the half. Juniors Steve Bednar (13 points), a guard, and Rendean Peery (12), a center, led the Bulldogs.

West Geauga 53, Lake Catholic 33 The victorious Wolverines, the No. 2 seed in the Division I district at Madison High, got 18 points each from Chad Murawski and Reggie King to easily oust the No. 6-seeded Cougars.

Harvey 86, Edgewood 47 In the other district semifinal at Madison, the No. 1-seeded Red Raiders coasted past the Warriors. Jeff Spikes led the winners with 18 points, 15 in the first quarter, while teammate David Alston added 17, 15 in the first half.

Windham 75, Chalker 56 The Bombers, the No. 1 seed in the Division IV district at Warren Harding, bombed out their Southington opponents as guard Phil Workman had 21 points and forward Zach Jacobson

added 20. Windham's victory was its 19th in 22 games.

Rittman 75, Richmond Hts. 56 In a Division IV district semifinal at Strongsville, No. 3-seed Rittman ousted the No. 2-seeded Spartans with outside shooting from guard Drew Fetter (19 points) and inside punch from center Kenny Peace (16). The two seniors were most responsible for closing Richmond Heights' season record at 15-7, though the Spartans did get 15 points from junior center David Malone.

Mapleton 62, Oberlin 59 A strong second half enabled the Mounties, now 5-18, to continue their amazing postseason play and oust No. 4-seed Oberlin, which was led by sophomore guard Morgan Jones' 17 points.

HIGH SCHOOL SCOREBOARD

BOYS BASKETBALL

DISTRICT SEMIFINALS

DIVISION I

COPLEY

At Copley High School

(1) Stow

(2) Firestone

Stow (14-9): Ricketts 10-2, Heisl 2-0-4, Redner 4-4-1, Peery 6-6-2, D'Antonio 2-4-4, Nutter 0-1-1, Cline 1-0-2.

Firestone (16-5): Mitchell 6-2-15, Jo. Pope 19-3-1, Royle 1-0-2, Johnson 2-0-4, Jo. Pope 2-2-8, Carter 2-5-9.

DIVISION II

FOURMANS

At Boardman High School

(1) Canfield

(2) McKinley

Canfield (14-2): Hotzel 2-3-7, Keating 2-0-6, Baker 6-7-19, Fox 1-1-3, Bellish 2-0-4, Carter 4-0-16.

McKinley (12-7): Muller 6-1-1, Resnerberger 4-4-13, Allen 4-2-11, Mellis 1-0-4, Cleary 4-1-11, Sussman 1-2-4, Krezewski 1-0-2.

DIVISION III

At Madison High School

(1) WG

(2) OLIC

West Geauga (16-4): n/a 0-1-1, Link 1-0-3, Holmes 2-0-5, Dickard 2-0-4, Murawski 2-0-4, Grog 2-0-16, Walcott 2-0-4, Lake Catholic 1-0-2, Greenwood 3-0-8, Salas 1-0-1, Tiedore 3-0-7, Spahr 2-0-5, Plungas 2-0-10.

DIVISION IV

At Strongsville High School

(1) Oberlin

(2) Mapleton

Oberlin (12-11): Chalmers 3-0-8, Manning 2-0-4, Bowen 3-2-8, Robinson 4-0-11, Jones 6-4-11, Dwyer 4-0-3.

Mapleton (11-15): Fetter 7-0-19, Trogon 6-1-15, Roemer 2-1-5, Peck 0-1-16.

DIVISION V

At Warren Harding High School

(1) Chalker

(2) Windham

Chalker (12-10): Forrest 1-0-2, A. Tietz 1-0-3, Tietz 5-0-11, Wick 1-0-3, McCreary 5-1-12, Gilman 3-0-7, Lettice 6-2-14, Brady 2-0-2.

Windham (19-9): Workman 7-5-21, Heller 4-0-9, Kellar 1-0-3, Logo 1-0-2, Morris 1-0-2, Asphor 5-1-15, Jacobson 10-0-20.

DIVISION VI

At Westlake High School

(1) Vermilion

(2) Olin Falls

Vermilion (15-7): Pena 3-0-4, Herber 3-6-11, Kott 1-1-3, Timbs 2-0-4, Ulfegren 1-0-2, Voreis 6-0-18.

Olin Falls (10-2): Stallard 3-1-7, Burger 2-0-5, D. Pellerite 3-2-8, Sparks 1-0-4-13, Brubaker 3-0-8, P. Pellerite 6-0-26.

DIVISION VII

At Elyria High School

(1) CVCA

(2) Channel

CVCA Valley-Cuyahoga (11-23): Smith 9-1-19, Davis 1-0-2, Holmes 1-0-2.

Channel (17-7): Quigley 5-1-13, Kelley 6-1-4, Berger 2-1-5, Wallentz 3-0-8, Brown 2-0-6.

DIVISION VIII

At Canton Memorial Civic Center

(1) Stow

(2) Mentor

Stow (22-3): Jennings 6-2-14, Padon 2-0-4, Schaffer 1-0-2, Cianchetti 4-2-13, Ritchie 3-4-5, Wagers 3-3-6.

Mentor (17-7): Quigley 5-1-13, Kelley 6-1-4, Berger 2-1-5, Wallentz 3-0-8, Brown 2-0-6.

DIVISION IX

At Warren Harding High School

(1) Canfield

(2) McKinley

Canfield (14-2): Hotzel 2-3-7, Keating 2-0-6, Baker 6-7-19, Fox 1-1-3, Bellish 2-0-4, Carter 4-0-16.

McKinley (12-7): Muller 6-1-1, Resnerberger 4-4-13, Allen 4-2-11, Mellis 1-0-4, Cleary 4-1-11, Sussman 1-2-4, Krezewski 1-0-2.

DIVISION X

At Lakeland Community College

(1) Py. Vly

(2) Berchler

Py. Vly (17-4): Williams 3-0-8, Bart 4-0-8, Hall 6-3-15, Dawson 3-1-7, Richardson 2-0-16, Hoops 1-1-3, Hanks 2-1-13.

Berchler (11-11): Kunka 8-11-29, Schroeder 1-0-2, Sepey 2-0-6, Rojas 4-1-10.

Wilson 1-0-2, Karas 1-0-2.

DIVISION XI

At Copley High School

(1) Ursuline

(2) JPK

Ursuline (18-4): McGarrity 2-2-3, Williams 6-1-23, Paterman 3-0-6, Ricci 1-1-3.

JPK (10-2): Warren John F. Kennedy (14-0): Howard 2-0-6, Chicchello 1-0-2, Townsend 2-0-5, Hainsworth 1-0-2, Gammill 1-0-2, Brown 2-0-5, Jackson 7-0-17, Procopio 1-0-2, McCullum 0-1-1.

DIVISION XII

At Wooster High School

(1) Lou Aquinas

(2) Manchester

Lou Aquinas (13-13): Hall 1-0-2, Manchester (13-18): Hall 1-0-2, St. Thomas Aquinas (13-10): Wash- ington 3-0-8, Hoffman 1-3-5, Grimm 2-0-4, Herli 10-2-22, McClelland 1-0-2, Robinson 1-0-3, Smith 1-0-2.

Manchester (13-18): Hall 1-0-2, St. Thomas Aquinas (13-10): Wash- ington 3-0-8, Hoffman 1-3-5, Grimm 2-0-4, Herli 10-2-22, McClelland 1-0-2, Robinson 1-0-3, Smith 1-0-2.

DIVISION XIII

At Strongsville High School

(1) Rich. Hts.

(2) Rittman

Rich. Hts. (15-7): Coleman 3-0-8, White 5-1-14, Hartford 3-1-7, Hall 1-0-2, Burton 0-3-3, M. Malone 3-0-6, D. Malone 2-0-1.

Rittman (14-9): Boreman 2-5-9, Gregory 4-2-11, Fetter 7-0-19, Trogon 6-1-15, Roemer 2-1-5, Peck 0-1-16.

DIVISION XIV

At Strongsville High School

(1) Oberlin

(2) Mapleton

Oberlin (12-11): Chalmers 3-0-8, Manning 2-0-4, Bowen 3-2-8, Robinson 4-0-11, Jones 6-4-11, Dwyer 4-0-3.

Mapleton (11-15): Fetter 7-0-19, Trogon 6-1-15, Roemer 2-1-5, Peck 0-1-16.

DIVISION XV

At Warren Harding High School

(1) Chalker

(2) Windham

Chalker (12-10): Forrest 1-0-2, A. Tietz 1-0-3, Tietz 5-0-11, Wick 1-0-3, McCreary 5-1-12, Gilman 3-0-7, Lettice 6-2-14, Brady 2-0-2.

Windham (19-9): Workman 7-5-21, Heller 4-0-9, Kellar 1-0-3, Logo 1-0-2, Morris 1-0-2, Asphor 5-1-15, Jacobson 10-0-20.

DIVISION XVI

At Westlake High School

(1) Vermilion

(2) Olin Falls

Vermilion (15-7): Pena 3-0-4, Herber 3-6-11, Kott 1-1-3, Timbs 2-0-4, Ulfegren 1-0-2, Voreis 6-0-18.

Olin Falls (10-2): Stallard 3-1-7, Burger 2-0-5, D. Pellerite 3-2-8, Sparks 1-0-4-13, Brubaker 3-0-8, P. Pellerite 6-0-26.

DIVISION XVII

At Canton Memorial Civic Center

(1) Stow

(2) Mentor

Stow (22-3): Jennings 6-2-14, Padon 2-0-4, Schaffer 1-0-2, Cianchetti 4-2-13, Ritchie 3-4-5, Wagers 3-3-6.

Mentor (17-7): Quigley 5-1-13, Kelley 6-1-4, Berger 2-1-5, Wallentz 3-0-8, Brown 2-0-6.

DIVISION XVIII

At Warren Harding High School

(1) Canfield

(2) McKinley

Canfield (14-2): Hotzel 2-3-7, Keating 2-0-6, Baker 6-7-19, Fox 1-1-3, Bellish 2-0-4, Carter 4-0-16.

McKinley (12-7): Muller 6-1-1, Resnerberger 4-4-13, Allen 4-2-11, Mellis 1-0-4, Cleary 4-1-11, Sussman 1-2-4, Krezewski 1-0-2.

DIVISION XIX

At Lakeland Community College

(1) Py. Vly

(2) Berchler

Py. Vly (17-4): Williams 3-0-8, Bart 4-0-8, Hall 6-3-15, Dawson 3-1-7, Richardson 2-0-16, Hoops 1-1-3, Hanks 2-1-13.

Berchler (11-11): Kunka 8-11-29, Schroeder 1-0-2, Sepey 2-0-6, Rojas 4-1-10.

DIVISION XX

At Canton Memorial Civic Center

(1) Stow

(2) Mentor

Stow (22-3): Jennings 6-2-14, Padon 2-0-4, Schaffer 1-0-2, Cianchetti 4-2-13, Ritchie 3-4-5, Wagers 3-3-6.

Mentor (17-7): Quigley 5-1-13, Kelley 6-1-4, Berger 2-1-5, Wallentz 3-0-8, Brown 2-0-6.

DIVISION XXI

At Warren Harding High School

(1) Canfield

(2) McKinley

Canfield (14-2): Hotzel 2-3-7, Keating 2-0-6, Baker 6-7-19, Fox 1-1-3, Bellish 2-0-4, Carter 4-0-16.

McKinley (12-7): Muller 6-1-1, Resnerberger 4-4-13, Allen 4-2-11, Mellis 1-0-4, Cleary 4-1-11, Sussman 1-2-4, Krezewski 1-0-2.

DIVISION XXII

At Lakeland Community College

(1) Py. Vly

(2) Berchler

Py. Vly (17-4): Williams 3-0-8, Bart 4-0-8, Hall 6-3-15, Dawson 3-1-7, Richardson 2-0-16, Hoops 1-1-3, Hanks 2-1-13.

Berchler (11-11): Kunka 8-11-29, Schroeder 1-0-2, Sepey 2-0-6, Rojas 4-1-10.

NEWSWATCH

Johnson to coach at alma mater Elyria

From staff reports

Elyria has hired Jodie Johnson, a former star player for the Pioneers, to replace longtime coach Carol Russo as volleyball coach.

Johnson, a 1995 graduate, was an all-state player and winner of the Lorain County Miss Volleyball award. After high school, she played volleyball at Edinboro University, where she was a three-time All-Pennsylvania State Athletic Conference selection. She was the conference and regional player of the year in 1999.

"We're very excited," said Russo, who is retiring at the end of the school year with 555 victories in 28 seasons. "Jodie never really left the program. She's always come to work in the summer to run camps. She has stepped in as a freshman coach. She knows the kids and she brings a very high level of energy and excitement. She's pumped to come here."

Johnson will teach health and physical education, as Russo did. She was the varsity volleyball coach at Wheeling Park High, in Wheeling W.Va., for three seasons. Her teams improved each season, going from 8-18 in 2002 to 16-14 in 2004.

"It's a perfect fit," Russo said. "The program is going to be in very good hands."

— Bob Migra

Copley-SVSM game sold out: Tonight's Division II boys basketball district semifinal at Barberton between undefeated Copley and nine-time district champ St. Vincent-St. Mary is sold out, tournament director Larry Bidlingmyer said.

No tickets will be sold at the door.

Eagles remain eighth: St. Edward remains eighth in this week's USA Today Super 25 national boys basketball poll.

The Eagles (21-0) continue tournament play today against Rhodes in a 7 p.m. Division I district semifinal at Bklynville.

Listings

Listings is a service of The Plain Dealer to help schools find opponents and coaches. To view the complete list, go to cleveland.cstv.com.